

The Whiteley News Bulletin

www.thewhiteleyhomestrust.org.uk



The Whiteley
Homes Trust

**Thursday 2nd
April 2026**

March Resident Engagement Session report

We saw a fantastic turnout from the village with around 150 residents attending in the Village Hall. The new style format proved popular once again with many saying it allowed more voices to be heard. Patricia Green said that in 17 years, it was 'the most fun, productive and informative engagement session' she'd ever been to!



There were lots of questions and suggestions gathered from the table discussions. We've provided a summary along with our responses as a separate attachment to this Bulletin.

Thank You to Barry, Chair of the WVRC

On behalf of the Trust, we would like to extend our sincere thanks to Barry as he steps down from the role as Chair of the WVRC after two years of dedicated service.

During his tenure, Barry has worked tirelessly to support and champion the needs of residents, particularly through what has been a challenging period. His commitment and willingness to engage with both residents and the Trust's management team have made a meaningful difference to the community.

We are especially grateful for the support he has shown to the new management team. This has been a period of significant change and improvement, and his collaborative approach has played an important role in helping to reset and strengthen the relationship between the Trust and residents. Together, we have made strong progress in building trust, increasing engagement, and ensuring residents have a greater voice in shaping their community.

As we mark this transition, we are also pleased to welcome Beryl as the new Chair of the WVRC. Having already served as Vice Chair, she brings valuable experience and insight to the role. We wish her every success and happiness as she takes on this position and look forward to working closely with her to build on the strong foundations that Barry, as the outgoing Chair, has helped establish.

Once again, thank you Barry, for your dedication, leadership and positive contribution. Your efforts are truly appreciated, and we wish you all the very best for the future - including more time to enjoy your hobbies, while continuing to play an active part in village life.



Introducing the Resident Voice Panel (RVP)

A successful 'getting to know you' meeting has taken place and members have taken part in a discussion that introduced policy scrutiny. Members of the RVP will also have training on how to effectively scrutinise performance and information and how to chair and facilitate RVP meetings. The first area of scrutiny will be identified from the outcome of the resident survey.

Resident Handbook

The new Resident Handbook, which was launched at the Engagement Session is now available to view and download from the main website:

www.thewhiteleyhomestrust.org.uk Click the 'About Us' tab and then the area called 'Publications & Policies'. This document has been a joint project with residents taking a very active role. We are very grateful for the input from the Resident Readership Panel and the WVRC.

At the Resident Engagement Session many residents commented that the original design may have been difficult for some people to read. We have listened and changed the design to a white background with black text.

If you would like a printed copy, please let Paul Stewart know by the end of April by emailing: news@whiteleyvillage.org.uk or calling 01932 504886. Printed copies will then be produced and distributed in early May.

New Parking Arrangements that are detailed in the handbook have now come into effect.

Open Day 15th April

On Wednesday 15th April we will be hosting an open day to encourage more external interest in the Borough and surrounding areas for housing applications. Contacts in housing, from the Council and other influential and well-connected individuals have been invited to attend. We have asked attendees to come to Huntley House and they will then be shown around the village, inside properties and taken on a tour to see some of the other facilities. There won't be any disruption to your normal day, but you may see members of the team showing people around so please do come along and say hello.

Signage

After residents told us that the signage in the village is inadequate, we conducted a full review of the signs and are pleased to let you know that a contractor will be on site during w/c Monday 13th April to update and replace the old signs. We will also be making improvements to the West Gate sign and adding notices for dog walkers.

Welcome to the team!

We welcome the following new members to the Whiteley team:

Jane Major – Registered Manager, Huntley House

I was born in Walton-on-Thames and have lived there all my life. My first job was in a nursing home as a health care assistant. Over the years I have had a variety of jobs but have always found my way back to the care sector. My most recent position was as a Deputy Manager of supported living for 18- to 65-year-olds but I soon realised that my vocation is working with older people. I am excited to join The Whiteley Homes Trust and get to know everyone at Huntley House.

Stephen Cox – Support Worker

I have always worked in customer facing roles and feel that I am very much a people person. After a brief stint as a counsellor, I moved into mental health support work. One of my main roles was a support worker at Richmond Fellowship, supporting people with diverse needs to find housing, education and employment. I found this kind of support work very rewarding. Most recently I have been working at Look Ahead Housing Support in Walton, helping people of all ages to avoid homelessness and sustain their tenancies.

Georgin Andrews - Support Worker

I moved to England four years ago and have been working in the support sector for the past three years. I started my career with an agency before moving to Midway, where I have found the role both enjoyable and rewarding.

I hold a Bachelor of Business Administration degree and a master's degree in international business management. These qualifications have helped me develop

strong communication, organisational and problem-solving skills, which I apply in both my professional and personal life.



Jane Major
Registered Manager



Stephen Cox
Support Worker



Georgin Andrews
Support Worker

Estates Team update

Following resident feedback, the following works have been scheduled or completed:

- The steps to the entrance of the Clubhouse are being re-laid and levelled in the coming months
- Crown Consultants will be coming in to conduct the annual tree condition survey which forms part of our health and safety tree assessment
- Landscaping the roundabout outside Huntley House will be completed by 15th April
- New oak pergolas have been installed in the Memorial Garden as these were in poor condition
- The Rhododendron clearance programme in the south end of the woods will reconvene mid-April.
- We have recruited a new Estate Grounds worker due to start at the end of April.

If you would like help with any light gardening, weeding or potting, Penny will be available on Mondays from 10am – 12.30pm. Call Lois or Sarah on 01932 842360 to

discuss what you might need and to book this **FREE** service. Penny does not cut grass or handle anything strenuous.

Community Café

Make sure you visit the Community Café over the Easter period (Good Friday, Saturday or Easter Monday) as there will be lots of Easter treats to choose from. Please note, the opening times for the Café over the Easter period are as follows:

Good Friday: 10am - 4pm

Saturday: Normal opening hours (10am - 8pm)

Easter Sunday: **Closed**

Easter Monday: 10am - 4pm

Also, please meet the five new members of the Café Team (l-r) Vincent, Toni, Lorraine, Ella and Adam.



Vincent Decamps – I have spent most of my career working in hospitality, including running my own French bakery and café locally. Some colleagues and residents may

already recognise me from that time, which makes joining Whiteley Village particularly meaningful for me.

Toni Mckey – I was born in Zimbabwe but have travelled back and forth and lived in UK for 10+ years of my life – mostly London in my early 20s and then the Northeast and Essex. I am new to Surrey, but I love it. I look forward to working in a relaxed, fun and social environment with you all.

Lorraine Rowbottom – Since leaving school in 1978 I have had many job roles, starting as a Kennel Maid in Staines and up to most recently as a Housing Support Officer in Reigate. My main career has been in Social Care, working as a Healthcare Assistant for Care Agencies and as a Support Worker, supporting individuals with challenging behaviours and Learning Disabilities.

Ella Croxford – After finishing school, I went to college to study Hairdressing. After completing this qualification, I worked in a salon for 2 years, however I decided that being a hairdresser wasn't for me. I'm really looking forward to joining the café team in Whiteley Village.

Adam Claydon will be known to many of you as a Support Worker in Huntley House who has now also become part of the Café Team.

We've also launched a new Tripadvisor page for the Community Café. We'd really appreciate it if you could scan the QR code below and leave a review. This will encourage others to come along and help it grow even further:



Community Team updates

The ACS Colliery Band will be here to play live music on **23rd April** on the terrace at the **rear of the café from 12noon – 1pm**. If the weather is cold or wet, they will be in the Village Hall.

Chikoo will be here with his **free IT clinic on Monday 20th April from 10am – 12noon** at the IT area in the Communal Lounge in Huntley House. Please come along for any technology questions you may have.

Cover for the village and services over the Easter period are as follows:

	Community Café	Shop & Post Office	Village Driver	Caretaker Team
Good Friday	10am – 4pm	Closed	10am – 4pm	11am – 10pm
Saturday	10am – 8pm	9am – 12noon	10am – 4pm	11am – 10pm
Easter Sunday	Closed	Closed	-	11am – 10pm
Easter Monday	10am – 4pm	Closed	-	8am – 7pm

The Caretaker Team will be happy to provide transport to the Café on Saturday evening or Easter Monday. Call them on **01932 825832**

Mental Health Awareness Week is 11th – 19th May and this year the theme is Community. We are planning a programme of events for residents to participate in, with activities focused on participation, inclusion and wellbeing. We will be dropping the schedule through everyone's door soon and please look out for it and come along to as many of these activities as possible.

Church Services in April

Community Church services will take place on the Sundays below, at **10.30am** in Huntley House during April with the following Ministers serving:

5th David Ritchie Easter celebration

12th Sue James
19th David Ritchie Communion
26th Mike Barnard

Community Services will be taking place with the following Ministers at **St. Mark's Church** on the following dates in April:

5th Rev'd Rod Jones
12th Community Service
19th Rev'd Michael Dunk
26th Community Service

As usual, on the fourth Sunday of the month, congregants are invited to take Communion at St. Peter's Church, Hersham which this month is on **April 26th**.

The Trust will pay for transport to and from St. Peter's Church for any resident wishing to attend the service.

Help with High Energy Costs

For those people with higher energy bills, there is the option of comparing tariffs and seeing what additional benefits your provider may offer. Some suppliers offer what is sometimes called a Hardship Fund.

If you would like help to discuss what options may be available to you, please contact the Housing Team on 01932 825844 or housing@whiteleyvillage.org.uk

The next Bulletin is due out on Thursday 7th May